



Grade 1 Science

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 1 · FULL YEAR

160 min per week · 2 lessons weekly

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This overview is drawn from the Florida course description and Optima's 2026–27 course plan rather than a fully built course, so scholars may see some variation in investigations, examples, and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Science Grade 1 builds a foundational understanding of life, physical, and Earth and space science through hands-on investigation. Scholars make careful observations, model and describe patterns, and explain how they know what they know, exploring science through immersive wonder-and-discover experiences while strengthening precise language and narration as they record findings. Each week pairs one concept lesson with one hands-on investigation, and scholars keep a science notebook of their observations and drawings.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 The Nature of Science (body of knowledge)

Raising questions about the natural world, using the five senses as tools to observe and describe objects, keeping pictorial and written records, and asking "how do you know?"

2 Earth and Space Science (body of knowledge)

Stars in the night sky, gravity, how magnifiers help us see, the helpful and harmful properties of the Sun, and the water, rocks, soil, and living things found on Earth's surface.

3 Physical Science (body of knowledge)

Sorting objects by observable properties, including whether they sink or float; describing the many ways objects move; and changing an object's motion with a push or a pull.

4 Life Science (body of knowledge)

Observing living things with the five senses, the major parts of plants, telling living from nonliving, how offspring resemble their parents, and the basic needs of plants and animals.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Two science lessons each week.
- The first introduces a core idea through reading, examples, and guided observation.
- The second is hands-on: an investigation, sorting task, or simple experiment where scholars observe, describe, and record.
- Scholars keep a science notebook of their observations and labeled drawings.

TIME COMMITMENT

160 minutes / week

two lessons a week, about 80 minutes each

- Each week pairs one concept lesson with one hands-on investigation.
- Investigations and projects may run a little longer.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A science notebook for observations and labeled drawings.
- Simple household materials for hands-on investigations.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- An adult to help young scientists with hands-on activities (especially in Kindergarten).

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting twice a week on the school's weekly schedule.